

Anti-Bogus-Anti

Q My computer is infected with WinAntivirus Pro 2007 and PestCapture, which I had installed thinking they were anti-virus and anti-spyware programs. I later learnt about them being bogus... how do I remove them?

N Venugopal

A Download these programs to your desktop and install them: SmitRem from <http://noahdfear.geekstogo.com>, SmitFraudFix from <http://siri.geekstogo.com/SmitfraudFix.php>, RogueRemover from www.majorgeeks.com/RogueRemover_d5360.html, HijackThis from www.merijn.org/files/hijackthis.zip, and CCleaner from www.ccleaner.com.

That done, reboot into Safe Mode. Open the SmitRem folder and double-click RunThis.bat to start the SmitRem removal procedure. Next, open SmitFraudFix and choose to search (option 1) and clean (option 2) and run a full system scan to remove anything it finds. Then, run RogueRemover. While still in Safe Mode, run CCleaner. Analyse and clean the files it finds, then click on the Issues button and Scan and Fix any Registry issues CCleaner discovers. Run both



the Registry Scanner and the File Analyzer until nothing more is found.

Run Hijackthis and Remove any leftover issues. Do not delete anything with Hijackthis unless you are absolutely sure what the file is and what it does. For items in the Hijackthis log like the following, which will not get deleted manually, use KillBox (killbox.clickhereformoreinfo.com) to browse to the location of the file and delete it or delete it on reboot. Items that are impossible to remove unless using Killbox usually show up in the "20" section of Hijackthis, for example:

O20-Winlogon	Notify:	msupdate-
C:\WINDOWS\SYSTEM32\msupdate32.dll		
O20-Winlogon	Notify:	winrir32-
C:\WINDOWS\SYSTEM32\winrir32.dll		
O20-Winlogon	Notify:	dvd4free-
C:\WINDOWS\SYSTEM32\dvd4free.dll		

Reboot into normal mode. Scan your computer using online virus checkers such as those at www.kaspersky.com/virusscanner and <http://security.norton.com/sscv6/default.asp?productid=sarc&langid=ie&venid=sym>. Also download, install and thoroughly scan your system using a spyware removal tool such as Spybot Search & Destroy from <http://spybot.clickhereformoreinfo.com>.

As a matter of general practice, always install and use an anti-virus program, update it regularly, and never disable it (even when certain programs ask you to do so), especially when you are online.

A This happens because the settings in the boot.ini file are no longer correct, now that you have removed the Samsung drive. What you can do is edit boot.ini. To do this in Windows 98, at a command prompt, type in CD\ and press [Enter]. Now type Edit boot.ini and press [Enter]. This will open the boot.ini file, which will display partition information. Here, you need to locate the Windows XP partition string. It looks like this:

```
multi(0)disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(1)\windows="Microsoft Windows XP Professional" /fastdetect.
```

Take the digit next to the partition tag; subtract 1 from it, and save the file. You should now be able to boot into XP.

My Computer Boasts Of No Floppy

Q I run Windows 2000 Professional. Recently, my floppy drive stopped showing up in My Computer. All the other drives display correctly. Under Floppy disk controllers, in the Computer Management console, it says that the drive is working properly. What is the problem?

Vaibhav Shinde

A The BIOS doesn't seem to detect your floppy drive. Check the CMOS settings and see if the floppy drive is visible. Ensure that the CMOS is set to "Halt on all errors" and also check that the BIOS' "Report the floppy drive to the OS" setting is enabled. Another reason could be drive letter conflicts caused by software such as RAMdisk. The TweakUI PowerToy, available from www.microsoft.com/windowsxp/downloads/powertoys/xppowertoys.msp, can also cause drive letters to be hidden in Windows

Explorer and My Computer. If you have it installed, go to the Control Panel and double-click on TweakUI. In the My Computer tab, select the checkboxes of the drives shown as hidden. Click Close and restart.

Beating The Heat

Q I have a Celeron 1.2 GHz, a Mercury 815e motherboard, an 80 GB hard drive, and 256 MB of SD RAM. The problem is that my heat sink gets really hot (I can feel really hot air blowing towards my hand when I place it next to the heat sink), and as a result, the PC hangs or restarts. The CPU fan is working fine, but the BIOS setting doesn't show its rpm. I have another case fan, and the BIOS reports its speed. Is there a problem with my motherboard?

Piyush Lore

A You first need to make sure the CPU fan is working properly. Open your cabinet and make sure the fan rotates easily. Make sure the heat sink and fan blades are free from dust. Use a paint brush to clean these. If necessary, remove the fan and heat sink, clean them thoroughly, re-apply thermal paste and fix them back on to the CPU. To make sure it's a heating problem, you can try running the CPU with the same heat sink and fan on another motherboard. Another factor due to which the BIOS may not be reporting the rpm of the CPU fan correctly could be the CPU fan cable not being connected to the proper connector on the motherboard. Check for this. If all is in order and you still have an issue, you will have to opt for an external CPU fan kit, which will cost between Rs 200 and 300.